A feeling in colour or sound teacher and cover plan

BUILD Spring 1 Week 1 Monday 4 January 2027 P5 Year A Explore

Teach one 40 minute lesson. Both pathways use Explore. Use colour/sound to express a feeling.

Today: I can use a colour or sound to show a feeling.

Success criteria

I can choose a feeling for my art.

I can try two marks or sounds.

I can show my choice in my arts log.

Prepare before pupils arrive

For four pupils: four books or arts logs and four pencils.

Painting option: five small sheets, mats, five brushes, a small shared set of washable paint and one stable water pot per pair. Prepare two adult test swatches.

Sound option: hands or fingertips, no instrument or recording device required. Use soft knee taps only if comfortable.

Six scrap pieces for tests, drying space and cloths. Keep wet materials away from electrical items.

No-materials option: silent hand patterns or pupil-directed adult movement.

Set a clear stop signal and quiet option. Offer an invented feeling or abstract theme. Have the prior work or an honest catch-up trial ready for lesson two.

Timing

Arrival 0-3; Starter 3-6; I do 6-12; We do 12-18; Create 18-32; Review 32-37; Exit 37-40 minutes. Tidy in the final two minutes of Review.

Non specialist demonstration

0 to 15 seconds: Say: My made-up feeling is calm. Draw one long curve in the air.

15 to 30 seconds: Show short marks. Say: I tried two ways. I choose the curve because it flows.

30 to 45 seconds: Tap four soft slow beats, pause, then four quicker beats. Say: I can test sound too.

45 to 60 seconds: Point to the chosen test. Say: I keep my real choice and reason in my log.

Teaching the first twelve minutes

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Arrival 0 to 3 minutes

Pupil task: You can point, speak, sign or pass. Choose a made-up feeling: calm or full of energy. You do not need to tell a story about your life.

What to say: We can make art about a made-up feeling. Pick calm or full of energy, or use another word. You can show your choice in silence.

What good looks like: A pupil chooses or confirms a feeling. There is no demand for personal disclosure.

Materials free fallback: Point left for calm or right for energy. Confirm the choice aloud without interpreting it.

Check and response: Both choices are valid. Accept a pupil's own feeling word and any culturally different colour association.

Starter 3 to 6 minutes

Pupil task: Watch a slow hand wave. Watch two quick hand taps. Which might show calm? Can someone choose the other one? Say or show why.

What to say: I move slowly, then I tap twice. I think the slow move could show calm. Your idea may differ if you can show a reason.

What good looks like: The pupil links a feature such as speed or space to a feeling. An alternative interpretation is accepted.

Materials free fallback: Use just silent hand movements. Pupils may watch or direct the adult with one or two fingers.

Check and response: A slow wave might show calm because it moves gently. Quick taps could show calm for someone who enjoys a steady beat. Meaning depends on the maker.

I do 6 to 12 minutes

Pupil task: Watch two tiny tests. Colour: try a smooth line, then short marks. Sound: try a slow soft beat, then a faster beat. Pick one way to work. You do not need to do both.

What to say: My made-up feeling is calm. I try a smooth blue line. Next I try short blue marks. I choose the smooth line because it flows. For sound I try four slow soft taps, pause, then four quicker taps. I prefer slow taps for my calm piece. These are my choices, not rules.

What good looks like: The adult models two tests and a reason. Show that another colour, silence or different marks can express the same feeling.

Materials free fallback: Trace a smooth line in the air and show short silent taps with the fingers. The pupil can direct the adult's hand movement.

Check and response: The key is an intentional choice and reason. Blue does not always mean calm. Quiet sound is an option, and silence is a valid artistic choice.

Guided practice and making

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We do 12 to 18 minutes

Pupil task: Choose calm or energy for a class test. Tell the adult: slow or fast? Smooth or short? Try two versions. Keep one. Finish: We chose ___ because ___.

What to say: You choose the feeling. I will change only the speed or the marks. Which version fits your idea? Point to the choice, then I will read your reason back.

What good looks like: Every pupil makes a choice. The class compares two deliberate versions and gives a feature-based reason. The adult does not supply the pupil's feeling.

Materials free fallback: Make two silent hand paths. The pupil can point to a version or direct a partner, with adult confirmation.

Check and response: For example: We chose slow marks because they feel still. Accept a different reason if it links a visible or heard feature to the intended effect.

Create 18 to 32 minutes

Pupil task: In your book or arts log, choose a feeling. Try two tiny colour tests or two sound tests. Keep one and make a short piece. Say or show: I chose ___ because ___. Keep your tests. You can ask an adult to write your words.

What to say: Work in paint or sound. With paint, try two small marks on scrap before your piece. Keep water and paint on the mat. With sound, tap softly below talking volume, use four beats and a pause, and stop on my raised hand. Choose silence if sound is too much. Point to the version you keep and tell me why.

What good looks like: A short painting or sound pattern with two genuine trials, a pupil choice and a reason. A simple piece is complete for this lesson. An adult may handle materials under the pupil's direction.

Materials free fallback: Use a silent four-move finger pattern or an air drawing. A pupil may direct the adult. The adult records the sequence and exact confirmed words on the supplied log. No materials or device is needed for participation.

Check and response: Example sound piece: four slow soft taps, a pause, repeated once. Example painting: spaced curved blue marks. Each is a teacher model, not a required answer or pupil evidence.

Review and evidence

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Review 32 to 37 minutes

Pupil task: Stop and put tools down. Show one mark, beat or pause that you chose. Your partner says: I notice ___. Tidy your space. You can share with just the adult.

What to say: Tell the maker one thing you notice, not what they must be feeling. Ask: Is that the feeling you chose? Listen to their answer. We have two minutes to cap paint, wipe the mat and leave the piece flat to dry. Keep each pupil's tests for next lesson.

What good looks like: A respectful observation linked to a feature and a maker's confirmed intention. Tools are secure and work is stored flat. The pupil may share privately.

Materials free fallback: The adult repeats a silent pattern and asks the pupil to confirm one feature. No peer audience is required today.

Check and response: A useful observation is: I notice big gaps between the marks. A guess about a pupil's private life is not required or recorded.

Exit 37 to 40 minutes

Pupil task: Arts log: I tried ___. I chose ___ because ___. Next time I will ___. Point to, sketch or describe your real work.

What to say: Show what you actually made or tried. I can write your words, read them back and let you change them. Our log keeps your idea and one real next step. You may say the piece is still a test.

What good looks like: A dated arts-log entry records the form, trial, chosen feature and reason. Staff record the support actually used. No model answer is entered as pupil evidence.

Materials free fallback: Pupil confirms a choice by gesture. Adult makes a short witnessed record and reads it back at the next available recording opportunity.

Check and response: Example only: I tried two beats. I chose slow taps because I wanted calm. Next time I will add a pause.

Store and log

Use the final two minutes of Review for quiet tidy-up. Keep paintings flat to dry, cap wet materials and wipe mats. Sound and movement pupils retain a simple sequence plan or dated adult observation plus their words. Work-only images are optional. Store the actual first attempt and log together.

Cover teacher route

Read the task and make two tiny tests in paint, sound or silent hand movement. Let pupils choose a feature and make a short response. Use the same timings and log prompts. No specialist demonstration is needed. If prior work is missing, use a fresh trial with today's date.

Access and teaching decisions

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Adaptations and prompt ladder

Cognition and Learning: Show one instruction at a time. Model a small test, offer two choices, then fade the prompt. Read the artist description aloud when needed.

Communication and Interaction: Allow pointing, signing, speech or an adult scribe. Give processing time. Use I chose ___ because ___. Read scribed words back for correction.

SEMH: Use a fictional feeling or abstract idea. Let pupils choose form and audience. Offer a calm pause and agreed return cue. Public performance and personal disclosure are optional.

Sensory and Physical: Offer silent seated movements, large marks and pupil-directed adult handling. Keep sound below talking volume. Stop on a raised hand. Ask before touching work.

EAL: Plan in any language. Teach words through marks and gestures. Accept a labelled sketch or oral explanation. Check meaning before spelling.

1. Point to the place or instruction.
2. Ask a short question.
3. Rephrase the instruction.
4. Provide a scaffold or choice.
5. Model the first step only, then return the task.

Common mistakes and fixes

One colour always means one feeling - Ask the maker what the colour means to them. Accept different personal and cultural meanings.

Loud sound is needed to show energy - Use faster quiet taps, silent movement or a pause. All work stays below talking volume.

A neat picture is the only good outcome - Look for an intentional choice and a reason. Marks or a brief sound pattern can express an idea.

Feedback

Give one specific success and one next step. VF verbal feedback; WS worked with support; I independent; NS next step; // self-edit; ? read this back; E evidence retained; R responded. Use R only when pupil voice and an audience are present, one NS is set, and the pupil responds in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode. A saved image alone is not R.

Where this leads

Artists, designers and performers test ideas and explain their choices. These skills help when working to a brief.